



KILLZONE™ 2

Being a military shooter, you wouldn't expect much of a story from *Killzone 2*, and there really isn't one to speak of. It's only in the latter stages that some semblance of a story comes together to make things more interesting. The single-player campaign does seem on the short side though, and on normal (trooper) difficulty, completing it in under 10 hours shouldn't be much of a problem.

Visually, *Killzone 2* is stunning and the attention to detail is quite baffling. Everything from the weapon modeling and explosions to the texture detail and shadows will make you sit back in awe. A limited colour palette and a few instances of unimaginative level design are the only downers in what is otherwise a visually top-notch game and one that PS3 fans and Sony will use as a poster child for what can be achieved with the power of the PS3.

Although the game is set on an alien planet, lending it a bit of a sci-fi feel, everything from the movement physics to the weapon selection is very realistic. The levels and environments too, vary quite a bit. What starts out in the streets of a Helghan city, later moves through stone structures, vast open barren lands, and industrial complexes, to name a few. But while overall the levels are varied enough not to feel monotonous, you can't help but feel that *Killzone 2* doesn't deviate enough from the industrial wasteland-look that has been done so many times before in first-person shooters.

While few console games can compete with *Killzone 2* in the graphics department, it is the enthralling gameplay that is the most enjoyable aspect of the game. The thrilling gun battles, an intuitive cover system, clever enemy AI, and explosive set pieces all combine to deliver an intense gameplay experience that you won't soon forget. The clever enemy AI will make the use of cover all the more necessary. The enemies, who are spread out across various classes, will use different tactics to get to you. Many levels offer you



multiple routes to the next checkpoint, but the enemy will also use these multiple routes to flank you every chance they get. Every now and then, you will also be faced with bossfights that provide a great way to mix up the gameplay.

One key gameplay aspect that some may appreciate

